



File History is one of the most addictive features of Windows 8

automates this for you. While you continue to work, it will periodically save the copies of files that have changed.

Before using File History, you'll need to configure it. While you can search for it in Control Panel and then configure it, an easier way to launch it the first time is to go to any library and click on the File History button in the Home tab

of the File Explorer. You'd find the option to configure File History there. You'll need a separate physical disk than the one on which the OS has been installed. It doesn't matter if you have 2 partitions or 20 on the same physical drive where you have Windows 8 installed, none of them can be used to store file history. If you don't have an extra disk, you're pretty much out of luck and won't be able to use this feature.

Coming back to configuring File History, you can't use File History on just about any folder unless it's in a library. So if you have documents inside a folder which lives outside the Windows 8 installation drive then you'd have to include the folder to a library before backing it up using File History. That said, you can create a new library and include the folder in it. File History can work with any folder added to any library – it's not limited to the libraries available by default. However there are three folders which are backed up by File History irrespective of whether or not they're included in any library; they are Desktop, Contacts and Favorites.

You can configure the behavior of this immensely useful tool from the Control Panel. It resides at Control Panel > System and Security > File History. Opening that location will give you four options on the left pane:

- ▶ **Restore Personal Files:** This option will launch the File History application and allow you to restore files from the history. In the main interface, you'll find three buttons at the bottom – two buttons to scroll through the various times at which history was saved and one green colored button for restoring the file's version that you are currently viewing. We recommend not using this button. Instead select the files/folders/libraries manually and right-click the selected ones to get an additional 'Restore to' option. This will allow you to save the files in that snapshot of file his-